

Tennis Star Jannik Sinner Ends His Season Early to Rest His Knee

From: BBC Tennis Mined: 2026-10-06 5 min read

Jannik Sinner, the number one men's tennis player in the world, will not play again in 2026. The 25-year-old from Italy has an ongoing **injury** in his right knee.

Sinner has not played a match since July, when he won Wimbledon for the second year in a row. In a video on Instagram, he said that he and his doctors decided he needs **treatment** for his knee. He said he "needed to think about my long-term career" when he chose to end his season early.

Even with the **injury**, Sinner had an amazing year. He won 44 singles matches and lost only three. Between March and May, he won five **Masters 1000** tournaments in a row. These are some of the biggest events in tennis after the four **Grand Slams**. That streak made him the youngest man to win all of the different **Masters 1000** titles at least once, a feat called the "career Golden Masters."

Sinner won six titles in 2026 on all three types of tennis courts: hard, clay and grass. He reached the **semifinals** of the Australian Open and lost a surprise early match at the French Open. Then he bounced back to beat Alexander Zverev in the Wimbledon final.

Sinner also beat his big **rival**, Carlos Alcaraz of Spain, in the final of the Monte Carlo Masters. That win made Sinner number one in the world.

Now Zverev, who is ranked second, is likely to take over the top spot by the end of the year. Zverev won the French Open and the US Open this year. Sinner is a five-time Grand Slam champion.

Word Treasure

injury -- An injury is harm to the body, such as a hurt knee.

treatment -- Treatment is the care doctors give to help a body part heal.

Grand Slams -- The Grand Slams are the four biggest and most important tennis tournaments each year.

Masters 1000 -- Masters 1000 tournaments are top men's tennis events that rank just below the Grand Slams.

semifinals -- The semifinals are the round just before the final, with four players left.

rival -- A rival is someone you often compete against for the same goal.

Background you need

Professional tennis players earn ranking points by winning matches at tournaments, and the player with the most points is ranked number one.

The four Grand Slams, including Wimbledon, the French Open and the US Open, are the biggest tournaments, and the Masters 1000 events are the next most important for men.

Tennis is played on different surfaces such as hard courts, clay and grass, and each one changes how the ball bounces.

Players sometimes stop playing for a while to treat an injury so they can stay healthy for future seasons.

Break it down

LEAD: World number one Jannik Sinner will not play again in 2026

KEY EVENT: He and his doctors decided his right knee needs treatment

+ - WHO: Jannik Sinner, 25, from Italy

+ - WHEN: He has not played since winning Wimbledon in July

SEASON RECORD: 44 wins and three losses, five straight Masters 1000 titles, six titles on all three surfaces

RIVALRY: He beat Carlos Alcaraz in the Monte Carlo Masters final to become number one

WHAT'S NEXT: Second-ranked Alexander Zverev is likely to take the top spot by year's end

Why it matters

Even top athletes sometimes need to rest and heal, and Sinner's absence will likely change who finishes the year as the world's best men's player.

Test what you remember

1. Why will Jannik Sinner not play again in 2026?

- ☐ (A) He wants to play soccer
- ☐ (B) He has an ongoing right knee injury
- ☐ (C) He was suspended
- ☐ (D) He retired

2. What tournament did Sinner win in July?

- ☐ (A) Wimbledon
- ☐ (B) The Australian Open
- ☐ (C) The French Open
- ☐ (D) The US Open

3. How many singles matches did Sinner lose this year?

- ☐ (A) Three
- ☐ (B) Forty-four
- ☐ (C) Ten
- ☐ (D) None

4. What is the "career Golden Masters"?

- ☐ (A) Winning a gold medal at the Olympics
- ☐ (B) Being number one for ten years
- ☐ (C) Winning every Grand Slam in one year
- ☐ (D) Winning all of the different Masters 1000 titles at least once

5. Whom did Sinner beat in the Monte Carlo Masters final to become number one?

- ☐ (A) Novak Djokovic
- ☐ (B) Carlos Alcaraz
- ☐ (C) Alexander Zverev
- ☐ (D) Juan Manuel Cerundolo

6. Who is likely to become the new number one by the end of the year?

- ☐ (A) No one
- ☐ (B) Jannik Sinner
- ☐ (C) Carlos Alcaraz
- ☐ (D) Alexander Zverev

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: A 4: D 5: B 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Jannik Sinner: He said he needed to think about his long-term career and that he and his doctors decided his knee needs treatment.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):